

Characters assigned to the pupils:

Navel: in this scene you will play Navel. Navel thinks a lot about things, especially about the ones that have not happened yet. At the moment Navel is worried about moving up to middle school. When something is frightening, Navel may go quiet or become restless. Navel needs to understand better what these feelings are and what might help.

Student 1: in this scene you will play a pupil, boy or girl, it's up to you. This is a practical, straightforward person. When somebody is worried, this person tends to say: "It's nothing" or "Just don't think about it". It is not meant unkindly: it is simply how this person deals with difficulties, by looking for a quick solution. Sometimes, though, this person may not notice how much the other one is really struggling.

Student 2: in this scene you will play a pupil, boy or girl, it's up to you. This is a person who tries to put themselves in other people's shoes. When they see someone sad or worried, they try to understand better what is going on. They ask questions, they listen, and they try to find words that help to explain emotions.

Teacher: in this scene you will play a teacher, male or female, it's up to you. The teacher helps the class to pause and reflect. The teacher does not say who is right or wrong, but helps everyone to speak up and to listen. When things get heated, the teacher invites everyone to calm down and to think before reacting.

Instructions:

For each character you will find some parts left blank.

You can fill them in freely, but remember that you are not speaking as yourself: you are playing a character with specific traits.

When you choose what to say in the blank spaces, ask yourself:

- "What would this character really say?"
- "How would they react, in their own way of being?"

STORY A – “I won’t know anyone”

(Navel is standing by their desk, in silence. The others come in.)

Student 1:

Oh Navel, you’re not saying anything today... that’s odd.

Student 2:

You look different. Has something happened?

Navel:

No... well, yes.

It’s just that I keep thinking about one thing.

At middle school I probably won’t know anyone...

and when I think about it I feel _____.

Teacher:

Have you been feeling like this for long?

Navel:

For a while.

Because I imagine that on the first day _____

and then I think that _____.

Student 1:

Come on, you’re bound to know somebody.

You just have to _____

and you’ll see, it will be fine.

Student 2:

Maybe you’re afraid of _____.

Navel:

Yes... maybe I am.

And when I think about it, it’s as if _____.

Student 1:

But you can't react like that every time you picture the first day.

Navel (getting annoyed):

I react like this because _____!

Teacher:

Let's stop for a moment.

Maybe the thing that worries you most is _____?

Student 2:

If that were the case, you could try to _____.

Student 1:

Or you could also _____.

Navel:

I don't know...

part of me thinks it will be _____,

but another part thinks it could be _____.

Teacher:

Right now you feel mostly _____.

But if you try to _____ you might feel differently.

Navel:

Maybe so.

I still don't know how it will go, but I could start with _____.

STORY B – “The teachers will be too strict”

(Navel is silent while the others talk about middle school.)

Student 1:

Have you heard? They say the teachers at middle school are really strict!

Student 2:

Navel, are you all right?

Navel:

When I hear these things I feel _____.

Teacher:

What worries you most?

Navel:

I imagine that if I make a mistake _____

and then I think that _____.

Student 1:

But if you do your homework you won't have any problems. You just have to _____.

Student 2:

Maybe you're afraid of _____.

Navel:

Yes...

it's as if inside me _____.

Student 1:

You can't be afraid of the teachers before you've even met them.

Navel (getting upset):

I'm not afraid of them! It's just that _____!

Teacher:

Let's try to understand this better.

The hardest part is _____?

Student 2:

If that were the case, you could _____.

Student 1:

Or you could _____.

Navel:

Maybe I'm imagining the worst...

because part of me thinks that _____,

but another part thinks that _____.

Teacher:

Right now you feel mostly _____.

A first step could be _____.

STORY C – Robot – “What if my friends change?”

(Navel is watching their classmates during break time.)

Student 1:

What’s up? You seem far away.

Student 2:

Are you thinking about middle school?

Navel:

Yes...

I’m afraid that at middle school my friends _____

and that makes me feel _____.

Teacher:

What do you imagine might happen?

Navel:

I imagine that _____

and then I think that _____.

Student 1:

But that’s not necessarily true!

You can simply _____.

Student 2:

Maybe you’re afraid of _____.

Navel:

Yes...

when I think about it, it’s as if _____.

Student 1:

You can’t control everything.

Navel (frustrated):

I know! But it’s just that _____!

Teacher:

What is the thing that would make you feel worst?

Navel:

What would make me feel worst is _____.

Student 2:

If that were the case, you could _____.

Student 1:

Or you could _____.

Navel:

Part of me thinks I'll lose everyone,

but another part thinks that _____.

Teacher:

Right now you feel mostly _____.

A small step could be _____.

Navel:

Maybe so.

I still don't know how it will go, but I can _____.

STORY D – Control – “The subjects will be too hard”

(Navel is looking at their school diary, deep in thought.)

Student 1:

Are you already studying for middle school?

Student 2:

You look worried.

Navel:

I’m thinking that at middle school the subjects will be harder...

and that makes me feel _____.

Teacher:

What exactly do you imagine?

Navel:

I imagine that during the lessons _____

and then I think that _____.

Student 1:

But you just have to study a bit more.

You can simply _____.

Student 2:

Maybe you’re afraid of _____.

Navel:

Yes...

when I think about it, it’s as if _____.

Student 1:

You can’t always think of the worst.

Navel (raising their voice):

I’m not thinking of the worst! It’s just that _____!

Teacher:

Calm down.

What is it that really frightens you?

Navel:

What frightens me most is _____.

Student 2:

If that were the case, you could try to _____.

Student 1:

Or you could _____.

Navel:

Part of me thinks I won't manage,

but another part thinks that _____.

Teacher:

What is one small step you can take now?

Navel:

I could start with _____.